

Chocolate Cream Cheese Pie

Makes one 9-inch pie; 6 to 8 servings

- 12 ounces bittersweet chocolate, finely chopped
- 1½ cups heavy cream, chilled
- ¼ cup dark corn syrup
- Two 3-ounce packages cream cheese, softened
- 1 prepared crumb crust

CHOOSING A CRUST

Chocolate Cookie Crust (page 13), **Oreo Cookie Crust** (page 14), or **Vanilla Wafer Crust** (page 17) is great here.

DRESSING IT UP

Whipped cream and **Strawberry Mash** (page 130), together or separately, are great on top of this pie. Whipped cream and **Cranberry Dessert Sauce** (page 131) make another terrific combination. Or simply sift some unsweetened cocoa powder over the pie just before serving.

1. Put 2 inches of water in a medium-size saucepan and bring the pot to a bare simmer. Combine the chocolate, ½ cup of the heavy cream, and the corn syrup in a stainless-steel bowl big enough to rest on top of the saucepan. Place the bowl over the simmering water, making sure that the bottom of the bowl doesn't touch the water. Heat, whisking occasionally, until the chocolate is completely melted. Remove the bowl from the heat and set the mixture aside to cool until it is just warm, 5 to 10 minutes. Using an electric mixer, beat in the softened cream cheese until the mixture is smooth.
2. In a medium-size mixing bowl using an electric mixer, whip the remaining 1 cup heavy cream until it just holds stiff peaks. Gently fold the whipped cream into the chocolate mixture.
3. Scrape the filling into the prepared pie crust, smoothing the top with a rubber spatula. Cover the pie with plastic wrap and refrigerate it until the filling is completely set, at least 3 hours and up to 1 day.

*For
chocolate
cheesecake fans,
here's a simple
no-bake
dessert.*